Thomas J. Brailey | Resume

PhD Researcher in Political Science

Status: PhD Researcher, Nuffield College
Field: Security provision, sub-Saharan Africa, quantitative methods
Techs: R, Python, QGIS

Oxford, United Kingdom
tjbrailey.netlify.app
thomasjbrailey@gmail.com

Summary

PhD researcher focused on security provision in sub-Saharan Africa, with expertise in quantitative research methods and geospatial analysis. Experienced in managing large-scale survey projects, processing complex datasets, and applying advanced statistical techniques. Skilled in R, Python, and QGIS, with a proven track record of academic excellence and externally funded research. Experienced tutor in African politics and quantitative social science, and adept at leading teams to adopt reproducible, collaborative data workflows.

Experience

Research assistant - London School of Economics 2025-present

* Geo-referencing and digitizing administrative maps
* Using R/sf to visualize data collection process

Research assistant - University of Oxford 2022-2024

* Processed various large-N survey and observational datasets and conducted causal analysis in R
* Assisted with the publication of datasets and academic working papers

Pre-Doctoral fellow - Payments and Governance Research Program (J-PAL) 2020-2022

* Developed large-scale randomized control trials; analyzed and presented results to stakeholders
* Transitioned team to version control/GitHub/R workflow

Research assistant - Center for the Study of African Political Economy

* Developed a dataset of African election outcomes
* Analyzed data in R/ArcGIS

Lab assistant - Center for Peace and Security Studies 2018-2020

* Collected data on global military capabilities; implemented full pre-processing pipeline
* Visualized data for academic publications

Education

PhD in Political Science - University of Oxford (Oxford, UK) 2024-present

* Thesis title: Protection Regimes: Explaining the Provision of Security Across Sub-Saharan Africa
* Funded by the Economic and Social Research Council (ESRC)

MPhil in Comparative Government - University of Oxford (Oxford UK) 2022-2024

* Funded by the Clarendon Scholarship
* Grade: distinction

BSc in Data Analytics/Political Science - UC San Diego (San Diego, US) 2016-2020

* Winner of the Sanford Lakoff Award for the Most Outstanding Thesis
* Grade: summa cum laude